



State of Ohio Administrative Policy

State Fleet Vehicle Anti-Idling Policies

No: VF-05

Office of Fleet Management

Effective:

March 5, 2024

Issued By:

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I. Purpose

The Office of Fleet Management (OFM), within the Department of Administrative Services (DAS), supports [State Agencies](#) reducing fuel waste and the public's exposure to [State Vehicle](#) exhaust by limiting unnecessary [Idling](#) in State Vehicles. The purpose of this policy is to reduce the petroleum consumed and pollution emitted by State Vehicles and to improve air quality. The first occurrence of a defined term in the policy is in bold, italic type, and is hyperlinked to the definition in Section IV.

II. Scope

This policy applies to all [Drivers](#) of State Vehicles.

III. Policy

A. ***Responsibilities***: No Driver who operates a State Vehicle designed to operate on public roads shall allow a gasoline-powered or diesel-powered State Vehicle to Idle in excess of ten (10) consecutive minutes. No State Vehicle shall be left running and parked/unattended for any reason, except in the following situations:

1. The State Vehicle is forced to remain motionless on a public road because of traffic conditions over which the Driver has no control.
2. The State Vehicle is being used as an emergency vehicle in an emergency situation.
3. The State Vehicle is used for security that is required to idle at institutions.
4. The State Vehicle is used to provide heating/cooling to ensure the safety and health of the K-9 units.

5. The State Vehicle's engine is providing auxiliary power for activities other than heating or air conditioning, such as loading, refrigeration, well drilling, or farming.
6. Where required by a federal, state, or local law or official, but only to the extent necessary to comply with such requirement.
7. Where running the State Vehicle's engine is necessary for maintenance, servicing, repair, or diagnostic purposes.
8. Where running the State Vehicle's engine during adverse weather conditions to properly defrost/clear all windows of frost/snow/ice to ensure the safe operation of the State Vehicle.
9. Where the ambient air temperature is below 32 degrees Fahrenheit for gasoline or diesel-powered State Vehicles and Idling of the State Vehicle is necessary to ensure the safety or health of the passengers or Driver.

IV. Definitions

- A. State Agency. Every organized body, office, board, authority, commission, or agency established by the laws of the state for the exercise of any governmental or quasi-governmental function of state government regardless of the funding source for that entity, other than any state institution of higher education, the office of the governor, lieutenant governor, auditor of state, treasurer of state, secretary of state, or attorney general, the general assembly or any legislative agency, the courts or any judicial agency, or any state retirement system or retirement program established by or referenced in the Revised Code.
- B. Driver. Any employee of a State Agency, inmate, volunteer, or other Authorized Operator of a State Vehicle.
- C. State Vehicle. Includes automobiles, trucks, motor vehicles with auxiliary equipment, self-propelling equipment or trailers, aircraft, or watercraft, that are owned by a State Agency.
- D. Idling. Idling is a vehicle condition in which the engine will run, but the vehicle is not in motion. The vehicle's idling speed is set to be sufficient to keep the engine running but not the vehicle. When idling, the engine runs without any loads except the engine accessories, and without additional fuel via the gas pedal.
- E. Authorized Operator. Person approved or assigned by the State Agency to perform a specific type of duty or function.

V. Authority

ORC 125.832

VI. Resources

Document Name	Location
EPA Fuel Economy website	https://www.fueleconomy.gov/

Dept of Energy – Climate Change	https://www.energy.gov/science-innovation/climate-change
Dept of Energy – Vehicles	https://www.energy.gov/science-innovation/vehicles

VII. Inquiries

Direct inquiries about this policy to:

Office of Fleet Management
General Services Division
Ohio Department of Administrative Services
4200 Surface Road, Columbus, Ohio 43228

614-466-6607 | dasfleet@das.ohio.gov

State of Ohio Administrative Policies may be found online at
<https://das.ohio.gov/home/policy-finder/filter-policy-finder>

VIII. Revision History

Date	Description of Change
03/05/2024	Original policy.